

Mississippi Court Clerk's Guide For Locating a Court Interpreter For Limited English Proficiency (LEP) Cases

The Administrative Office of Courts ("AOC") is the entity charged with qualifying foreign language interpreters for the State of Mississippi. The AOC website is frequently updated to include all pertinent information regarding the certification and availability of foreign language interpreters:

<https://courts.ms.gov/aoc/courtinterpreter/courtinterpreter.php>

Appointing an interpreter is a matter of judicial discretion. It is the responsibility of the court to determine whether a participant in a legal proceeding has a limited ability to understand and communicate in English. The LEP may consequently have a limited ability to read, write or understand English and cannot equally participate in or benefit from the proceedings unless an interpreter is available to assist the individual.

An interpreter should be appointed with the following preferences: (1) CERTIFIED; (2) REGISTERED; (3) NON-CREDENTIALLED. *Certified* interpreters have passed all examinations and criteria promulgated by the AOC for certification. *Registered* interpreters are waiting to take the oral performance examination. *Non-credentialed* interpreters have either not been tested or have not passed any exam.

A non-credentialed interpreter should only be appointed upon a finding that diligent, good faith efforts to obtain a certified or registered interpreter have been made and none has been found to be reasonably available. Be very careful when using non-credentialed interpreters. There is a high possibility of interpreting errors, unintentional or not, that can directly affect the outcome of the case.

There are numerous resources to guide you and your staff when dealing with LEP individuals. Some of these resources are listed below:

Limited English Proficiency: A Federal Interagency Website: <https://www.lep.gov/state-courts>

National Center for State Courts: <https://www.ncsc.org/consulting-and-research/areas-of-expertise/language-access>



For questions or concerns, contact:

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Language Identification Flashcard ✓

☐

Arabic

أنا أتحدث اللغة العربية

☐

Armenian

Ես խոսում եմ հայերեն

☐

Bengali

আমি বাংলা কথা বলতে পারি।

☐

Cambodian

ខ្ញុំនិយាយភាសាខ្មែរ

☐

Chamorro

Motka i kahhon ya yangin ûntûngnu' manaitai pat
ûntûngnu' kumentos Chamorro

☐

Dinka

Rinp ëkënë yic të yïjam në thunjäy ye tök, ku kor raan
Bï yï geer thok.

☐

Simplified Chinese

如果你能读中文或讲中文，请选择此框。

☐

Traditional Chinese

如果你能讀中文或講中文，請選擇此框。

☐

Croatian

Govorim hrvatski

☐

Czech

Mluvím česky

☐

Dutch

Ik spreek het Nederlands

☐

English

I speak English

Language Identification Flashcard ✓

☐ Farsi

من فارسی صحبت می کنم

☐ French

Je parle français|

☐ German

Ich spreche Deutsch|

☐ Greek

Μιλώ τα ελληνικά

☐ Haitian Creole

M pale kreyòl ayisyen

☐ Hindi

मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ ।

☐ Hmong

Kuv has lug Moob

☐ Hungarian

Beszélek magyarul|

☐ Ilocano

Agsaonak ti Ilokano

☐ Italian

Parlo italiano|

☐ Japanese

私は日本語を話す

☐ Korean

한국어 합니다

Language Identification Flashcard ✓

☐

Laotian

ຂ້ອຍປາກພາສາລາວ

☐

Polish

Mówię po polsku

☐

Portuguese

Eu falo português do Brasil
(for Brazil)

☐

Portuguese

Eu falo português de Portugal
(for Portugal)

☐

Romanian

Vorbesc românește

☐

Russian

Я говорю по-русски

☐

Serbian

Ja говорим српски

☐

Slovak

Hovorím po slovensky

☐

Spanish

Yo hablo español

☐

Somali

Waxaan ku hadlaa af-Soomaali

☐

Tagalog

Marunong akong mag-Tagalog

☐

Thai

พูดภาษาไทย

Language Identification Flashcard ✓

☐

Tongan

Maaka 'i he puha ni kapau 'oku ke lau
pe lea fakatonga

☐

Ukrainian

Я розмовляю українською мовою

☐

Urdu

میں اردو بولتا ہوں

☐

Vietnamese

Tôi nói tiếng Việt

☐

Yiddish

איך רעד יידיש

☐

American Sign Language



I, ME



SIGN, SIGN LANGUAGE